

Variants • Chapter 4

Hypno and edits

Last checked 3 November 2026 • 9 minutes to read

Hypno edits are loops, spirals, captions and censored images built to be watched again and again. They are a craft with a safety limit, and some of them are also built to keep you spending.

Verified | Reported | Vivian's field notes

This chapter is not advice for your situation.

In 30 seconds

- A hypno edit works through repetition, sound and a frame you agreed to. It does not take over anyone's mind, and agreeing to play does not guarantee you can switch the effect off.
- A loop must never flash more than three times in any one second, and the point where it restarts counts.
- Censoring an image is a presentation choice. It does not replace marking a post as sensitive where the platform requires it.
- A sound or word used as a cue needs an off switch agreed before it is ever sent.

- Some captions, teases and overlays are designed to feed spending, and you can learn to see them.

You will learn

- What a hypno edit is made of, and what it cannot do.
- How to test a loop against the three-flash limit.
- How censored teasers, captions and sound are put together.
- Where cues and triggers must never go.
- How to spot an edit that is steering your spending.

A loop is patient. It repeats the same few seconds until you stop noticing that you are watching. I like the craft, and I measure it: how fast it flashes, how loud it is, and how you switch it off. A dom who skips those three questions is not playing with you. She is playing at you.

— **Vivian**

What a hypno edit is

Flashing content can trigger seizures and migraines in some people. Verified If you have photosensitive epilepsy, a history of seizures, or migraine set off by flicker, do not watch loops or spirals. Stop at the first symptom and get medical help; see Where to get help.

A hypno edit is a picture, loop or clip built to be watched many times. It might be a spiral, a doubled image, words passing one at a time, or a caption about melting minds.

Most of the effect comes from repetition, sound and a frame the viewer agreed to. A short phrase typed again between actions, a stock of short clips sent with the instruction to watch them again, and wallpapers that keep a character on a screen all day all work the same way.

In my experience repetition can build strong habits and pairings, and agreeing to play does not guarantee you can turn the effect off. That is why the off switch comes first.

Myth

A hypno edit can take over your mind.

Fact

It is a game of repetition, sound and suggestion that starts from your agreement to play, and that agreement does not guarantee you can stop the effect at will. Words such as brainwashed and addicted are part of the costume.

Myth

A censored teaser means a post needs no adult marking.

Fact

Censoring is a presentation choice and does not replace marking. Mark the account or post as sensitive wherever the platform requires it. Automatic adult marking is uneven in both directions, and an edit with nothing explicit has been marked anyway.

Myth

Pictures cannot hurt anyone.

Fact

Flashing content can cause migraines, dizziness, nausea and seizures in some people. Verified

The three-flash rule

The accessibility standard WCAG 2.2 sets a clear limit: a page must not contain anything that flashes more than three times in any one-second period, unless the flash stays below the general and red flash thresholds. Verified A flash is a pair of opposing changes in relative luminance. Verified In plain words, the brightness jumps one way and then back.

The size of the flashing area counts too. The standard gives a rectangle of 341 by 256 pixels as an estimate of the part of the screen that matters. Verified

The limit in one line

3 flashes per second at most, in any one-second window of the page, as of 2026-11-03.

Verified

A page that carries a loop should also respect the viewer's reduced-motion setting, which a browser reports as a request to reduce non-essential motion. Reported

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Vivian's field notes

My own rule is stricter than a habit. The point where a loop restarts counts, because a loop meets its own seam again and again. A loop that breaks the limit is slowed down or not exported, and a stop control has to cut everything in one frame. I test with a measurement, never by eye.

Check a loop before you post it

1. Export the loop at the frame rate it will be posted at.
2. Measure the brightness changes frame by frame with a tool, and do not trust your eyes.
3. Count the flashes, each one a pair of opposing brightness changes, in every one-second window, including the window that crosses the point where the loop restarts.
4. If any window holds more than three flashes, slow the loop, soften the contrast or remove frames, then measure again.
5. Offer a still or calmer version next to the loop for viewers who want less motion.

Edits that work

Censor craft. The usual pair is a censored teaser for the public feed and a full version without the censor for the people who paid, with the same loop length. The 2DFD editor made by Vivian exports that pair only when something is actually censored.

Censor styles and what to watch

	What it looks like	What to watch
Blur or mosaic	A soft or blocky cover	Compute it on exact averages so it does not look uneven
Noise or static	Grain over the area	The grain must survive the platform's compression
Bars, plates and shapes	Clean covers, or an eye bar with a word	Keep them above the subject in the layers
Tint, neon or patterns	A decorative cover	The area must still read as covered
A cover that follows the subject	It moves with the character	Check every frame of the loop
A free-drawn area	Covers all but one chosen detail	Draw it by hand and look again

Layer order decides whether a censor holds. Everything that covers stays above the subject, and the hypno effect is drawn after those layers, so a doubled image only copies what is already hidden. Grain that survives compression and a

preview scaled and recompressed like the feed are the details that make a teaser look right in the feed.

If a program finds the area to cover by itself, a person should confirm it before the export. A censor does not replace marking: mark a post as sensitive wherever the platform requires it, and expect that an automatic check can still mark an edit. See Posting and workflows for how marking works.

Captions. A caption says one thing. A draft that contradicts itself reads as lazy, and text on an image works better than the image alone.

Same idea, two captions

Quiet is boring, and I love how quiet you are.

Coherent

Quiet is what I asked for. Stay quiet.

Sound. Feedback on a clip is usually about sound. In my experience soft mouth noises beat a song, a slow ramp or a silent opening loses the listener, and a very long file is better cut to its strongest section. When effects are far too loud, lower the volume before rebuilding the edit. Binaural audio is a matter of taste, and I would not promise that it does anything specific.

Feedback from subs is often vague, and a few direct questions turn it into something a dom can use.

Turn vague feedback into questions

Example conversation. Invented for this exercise.

Them

It was too much.

You

Too loud, too fast or too big?

Them

Too fast, and the music was harsh.

You

Then a slower loop and a softer sound. I will send a new version. Tell me what you hear.

Cues and triggers

A cue is a short sound or word paired again and again with a reaction until the sound alone brings the reaction back. The idea is borrowed from clicker training, where a click marks the moment of a wanted behaviour. People who try a cue for the first time often find it stronger than they expected.

That is the reason to agree on the off switch before the first cue is ever sent.

Agree the off switch first

1. Say in plain words how the cue ends, and agree that either person may end it at any time.
2. Agree an ordinary phrase, used outside the scene, that means the cue is off.
3. Agree what the dom does when she hears it: stop sending the cue and say so.
4. Agree what the sub can do alone: delete the file, mute the sender, take a break.
5. Check in after a week. Does the cue still feel like play?

Arousal or trance-style content must never reach someone who is driving or operating anything, because it can cause an accident.

Red flags

Where a cue never goes

- The person is driving, riding or operating a machine.
- The person is at work or anywhere a strong reaction would be unsafe or unwelcome.
- The person has said no, or never agreed to cues at all.

Counter. Do not send it. If you receive a cue in one of these moments, stop the sound, and tell the sender that the cue is off.

A cue works too well

A sub tells you that since you started sending a click, he hears it in his head during the day and loses the thread of his work.

A Stop sending the cue, tell him it is off, and ask how he is

The right answer. Right. The off switch exists for this moment. Talk after the cue is off. If it does not fade once the cue has stopped, a doctor or a counsellor is the next step.

B Send a stronger version to settle him

Not this one. That adds more of the thing that causes the problem.

C Tell him it will pass and carry on

Not this one. It may pass, and carrying on takes away the choice that keeps it a game.

Making clips, rights and traces

Tips from people who make these edits, in the order they usually hit trouble:

- Make clips in segments of about fifteen seconds and join them. The first segment is usually fine, and the continuation often drifts, so plan to generate the second part again with a different prompt.
- In generated clips the payoff is often only a few seconds while the set-up fills the runtime. Trim the set-up and keep the peak.
- A character stays consistent with a long, detailed prompt, reference images of the outfit and a few key frames made beforehand. Skipping this wastes attempts.
- Joined clips show their seams, and ambient sound can make a clip feel wrong, so re-edit until pacing and sound fit.

- Free quotas end, and a series that depends on unlimited free generation can stop with them.
- Services differ in what they allow. Read each service's terms and use it only for what it permits.

Red flags

Rights and traces

- A clip that swaps your character into another creator's animation uses that creator's work.
- A cloned voice of an official game character can breach rights, above all for anything that is sold.
- A file carries traces of how it was made, such as a date, the name of a program and notes inside the file.

Counter. Make the footage yourself or get written permission, use only a voice you have the right to use, and use no real person's face or voice without consent. Check every file before it leaves your machine so that no personal data or file path travels with it, and never remove a label that a platform requires on AI-generated content.

Reusing another creator's clip with your character swapped in is cheap, and it is reuse of someone else's art. See Stolen art and persona theft and Art for your persona.

Pressure inside the loop

Edits are made to hold attention, and some of them hold it in order to feed spending. This section is written for the person who has to recognise the pattern and walk away from it.

Words of addiction are common in play, such as my drug, brainwashed and addicted. A support-group leader quoted in the press says addiction itself has become a fetish. Reported One author compared some cases of findom spending to problem gambling. Reported When the same words appear next to growing spending or lost sleep, treat them as a signal to set a cap or take a break.

What an edit can do to your spending

What they say or do

1 Another picture arrives, with the promise that the next one is better

The counter

The next one will be promised to be better too, so the promise never ends. Decide how many you want before you start.

What they say or do

2 A caption mocks your return or tells you to borrow in order to see more

The counter

It is designed to feed repeat spending. Closing the post costs nothing.

What they say or do

3 A hypno overlay sits next to a pay button

The counter

The peak of a loop is the worst moment to decide anything. Close the screen and wait a day.

What they say or do

4 A cue arrives just before a request to send

The counter

A sound paired with obedience works on the reaction, not on your judgement. Switch the cue off and keep the payment decision for later.

What they say or do

5 A blurred preview teases what you have not yet earned

The counter

The blur is the tease. It does not prove that the full version is worth anything.

A payment prompt at the peak of arousal is a bad moment to choose. One first-person account in the press asks whether consent is real when a client is too aroused to think straight and takes on credit-card debt.

Reported

If a loop is leaving you chasing the next one, go to The spiral. If a cue will not switch off, or you are distressed, see Where to get help. For the same patterns in other settings, see Pressure tactics, both ways.

Free, confidential helplines exist in most countries.

Find a helpline →

Check yourself

Question 1 of 3

What is the most a page may flash in any one second under WCAG 2.2?

- ◯ Ten times
- ◯ Three times
- ◯ As often as the sound allows

Answer. Three times. The limit is three flashes in any one-second period, unless the flash is below the general and red flash thresholds.

Question 2 of 3

Where do you count the flashes of a loop?

- ◯ Only in the middle of the clip
- ◯ In every one-second window, including the one that crosses the restart
- ◯ By eye, once

Answer. In every one-second window, including the one that crosses the restart. The seam counts because the loop meets it again and again.

Question 3 of 3

A sub who is driving receives a cue. What happened?

- ◯ A normal session
- ◯ Something that must never happen
- ◯ A reward

Answer. Something that must never happen. Arousal or trance-style content must never reach someone who is driving or operating anything.

Remember it

1. A hypno edit is repetition, sound and a frame you agreed to.
2. Three flashes in any one second is the limit, and the restart counts.
3. Measure a loop, never judge it by eye.
4. A censor is a presentation choice and does not replace marking.
5. Agree how a cue ends before the first one is sent, and never send one to a person at the wheel.
6. A payment prompt next to a loop is a signal to close the screen.

Check it

Every claim with its evidence level and its sources.

Evidence levels

Verified	Checked against the original source.
Reported	Stated by a serious secondary source read in full.
Community	Widely said in the scene; no document proves it.

Vivian's field notes — First-hand experience, not a study.

Unverified — Plausible, not proven yet.

1 Flashing content can trigger seizures and migraines in some people.

Verified

Understanding Success Criterion 2.3.1: Three Flashes or Below Threshold | WAI | W3C (https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/Understanding/three-flashes-or-below-threshold.html)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261001165853/https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/Understanding/three-flashes-or-below-threshold.html)

Accessed 3 November 2026

2 It might be a spiral, a doubled image, words passing one at a time, or a caption about melting minds.

Vivian's field notes

3 A short phrase typed again between actions, a stock of short clips sent with the instruction to watch them again, and wallpapers that keep a character on a screen all day all work the same way.

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9 A flash is a pair of opposing changes in relative luminance.

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11 Flashes per second at most, in any one-second window of the page, as of 2026-11-03.

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Accessed 3 November 2026

12 A page that carries a loop should also respect the viewer's reduced-motion setting, which a browser reports as a request to reduce non-essential motion.

Reported

prefers-reduced-motion CSS media feature - CSS | MDN (https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/CSS/Reference/At-rules/@media/prefers-reduced-motion)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261031201800/https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/CSS/Reference/At-rules/%40media/prefers-reduced-motion)

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28 People who try a cue for the first time often find it stronger than they expected.

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29 Arousal or trance-style content must never reach someone who is driving or operating anything, because it can cause an accident.

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30 The person is driving, riding or operating a machine.

Vivian's field notes

31 The person is at work or anywhere a strong reaction would be unsafe or unwelcome.

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32 The person has said no, or never agreed to cues at all.

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33 The first segment is usually fine, and the continuation often drifts, so plan to generate the second part again with a different prompt.

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45 A support-group leader quoted in the press says addiction itself has become a fetish.

Reported

[a former participant] has seen men left broke and hungry from 'paying women to talk to them' (https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20251123124217/https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Accessed 3 November 2026

46 One author compared some cases of findom spending to problem gambling.

Reported

The Psychology of Financial Dominatrixes (blog post) (https://www.psychologytoday.com/us/blog/in-excess/201612/the-psychology-financial-dominatrixes)

Accessed 3 November 2026

47 When the same words appear next to growing spending or lost sleep, treat them as a signal to set a cap or take a break.

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48 Decide how many you want before you start.

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49 Closing the post costs nothing.

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50 Close the screen and wait a day.

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51 Switch the cue off and keep the payment decision for later.

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52 It does not prove that the full version is worth anything.

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53 One first-person account in the press asks whether consent is real when a client is too aroused to think straight and takes on credit-card debt.

Reported

Diary of a Financial Dominatrix, part one (https://www.theskinny.co.uk/sexuality/deviance/diary-of-a-financial-dominatrix-part-one)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20200805021033/https://www.theskinny.co.uk/sexuality/deviance/diary-of-a-financial-dominatrix-part-one)

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Nothing here is financial, legal or medical advice for your situation.